



SESSION 3: MENTOR GUIDE

My goals

Be alert: many athletes have adopted goals from others. Your job is to uncover the real desire.

SESSION GOAL

Help the athlete distinguish between their own goals and imposed goals. Intrinsic motivation is the only sustainable engine.

CONVERSATION FLOW**OPENING (5 MIN)**

“If you could choose today without any limitation, what would you want to achieve?”

💡 Notice how spontaneous vs. how hesitant the answer comes. That says a lot.

EXPLORING (15 MIN)

“Is this goal something YOU want, or something others want for you? How do you know?”

💡 No judgment. “Both is possible too.” But help the athlete feel the distinction.

DEEPENING (10 MIN)

“Imagine you achieve this goal, how do you feel? What changes in your life?”

💡 This touches the deeper motivation behind the goal (identity, value, belonging).

CLOSING (5 MIN)

“What is the very first concrete step? Not the big leap, but the first step.”

💡 Small steps make big goals believable.

OBSERVE

- Are goals formulated spontaneously or slowly? (Fast = own. Slow = possibly from others.)
- What is the emotion behind the goal? Enthusiasm, obligation, fear, pride?
- Does the athlete mention others with their goals? ("My coach wants me to...", "My parents think...")
- Is there a goal they mention with hesitation or quietly? That's often the real goal.

△ NOTE

If an athlete has no own goals, don't force it. Use: "What made you enthusiastic earlier in life?" to return to inner motivation.

CLOSING

Name the ownership: "These are YOUR goals. Not your coach's or your parents'. We are going to help you achieve them." Powerful moment of giving agency.

MENTOR NOTES